

0.0.1 Makhadeva

makhādevasuttaṃ

1. Thus was heard by me: At one time the Auspicious One was dwelling at Mithila, in the Makhadeva Mango Grove. It so happened that the Auspicious One displayed a smile at a certain spot. Then of the venerable Ananda, this occurred: “What is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.” Then the venerable Ananda, having arranged his robe on one shoulder, having stretched out his hands in anjali towards the Auspicious One, said this to the Auspicious One: “What, O Bhante, is the cause? What is the reason for the Auspicious One’s displaying of a smile? Tathagatas do not display a smile without a cause.”

evaṃ me sutāṃ: ekaṃ samayaṃ bhagavā mithilāyaṃ viharati makhādevambavane. atha kho bhagavā aññatarasmiṃ padese sitaṃ pātvākāsi. atha kho āyasmato ānandassa etadahosi: ko nu kho hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe tathāgatā sitaṃ pātukarontī’ti. atha kho āyasmā ānando ekaṃsaṃ cīvaram katvā yena bhagavā tenañjalimpaṇāmetvā bhagavantam etadavoca: ko nu kho bhante hetu, ko paccayo bhagavato sitassa pātukammāya? na akāraṇe² tathāgatā sitaṃ pātukarontī’ti.

2. Once upon a time, O Ananda, in just this Mithila, there was a king named Makhadeva, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.

bhūtapubbaṃ ānanda, imissāyeva mithilāyaṃ rājā
ahosi makhādevo³ nāma dhammiko dhammarājā
dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāh-
maṇagahapatikesu negamesu⁴ cepi jānapadesu
ca. uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcada-
siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa.

3. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Makhadeva’s head. Having seen, he said this to king Makhadeva: “The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head.” “Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with

tweezers, place them in my cupped hand.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Makhadeva, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Makhadeva’s cupped hand.

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo bahunnaṃ⁵ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni⁶ jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena rañño makhādevassa sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna rājānaṃ makhādevaṃ etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni⁶ jātāni’ti. tena hi samma kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena ud-dharitvā mama⁷ añjalismiṃ paṭiṭṭhāpehī’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa paṭissutvā tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena ud-dharitvā rañño makhādevassa añjalismiṃ paṭiṭṭhāpesi.

4. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey

hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man.”

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kappakassa gā-mavaram datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram āmantā-petvā etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mānusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesituṃ. ehi tvam tāta kumāra, imaṃ raj-jaṃ paṭipajja. ahaṃ pana kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagā-riyaṃ pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha

kappakassa gā mavaram datvā jetṭhaputtam kumāram sādhu kam rajje samanūsāsivā kesamasum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agā rasmā anagāriyam pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇam vaṭṭam¹ nihitam anuppavatteyyāsi. mā kho me tvam antimapuriso ahosi. yasmim kho tāta kumāra, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāham tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇam vaṭṭam nihitam anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvam antimapuriso ahosī'ti.

5. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction,

likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

atha kho ānanda, rājā makhādevo kappakassa gā-mavaraṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhukaṃ rajje samanūsāsitaṃ imasmiṃyeva makhādevam-bavane kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajī. so met-tāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ,² iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sab-bāvantāṃ lokaṃ mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ² iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sab-bāvantāṃ lokaṃ upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi.

6. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the

kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

rājā kho panānanda, makhādevo caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīḷitaṃ kīḷi, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjaṃ³ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rājjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedā paramma-
raṇā brahmalokūpago ahosi.

7. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Makhadeva's son addressed his barber: "when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me." "Yes, your majesty," O Ananda, the barber replied to king Makhadeva's son. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Makhadeva's son's head. Having seen, he said this to king Makhadeva's son: "The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head." "Well then good barber, having carefully

pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Makhadeva’s son, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Makhadeva’s son’s cupped hand.

atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena kappakaṃ āman-
tesī: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi siras-
miṃ palitāni jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ti. evaṃ
devāti kho ānanda, kappako rañño makhādevassa
puttassa paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kap-
pako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatā-
naṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena rañño
makhādevassa puttassa sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni.
disvāna rañño makhādevassa puttaṃ etadavoca:
‘pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, dissanti siras-
miṃ palitāni jātāni’ti. tena hi samma kappaka,
tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā mama
añjalismiṃ patiṭṭhāpehi’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda,
kappako rañño makhādevassa puttassa paṭissu-
tvā tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā
rañño makhādevassa puttassa añjalismiṃ patiṭ-
ṭhāpesi.

8. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva’s son, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son

prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved of hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man.”

atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto kappakassa gāmvaram datvā jetṭhaputtam kumāram āmantāpetvā etadavoca: ‘pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dissanti sirasmim palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mānusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesitum. ehi tvam tāta kumāra, imam rajjam paṭipajja. aham pana kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyam pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta

kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha kappakassa gā mavaram datvā jetṭhaputtam kumāram sādhu kam rajje samanussāsivā kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyam pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idaṃ kalyāṇam vaṭṭam nihitam anuppa vatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosi. yasmim kho tāta kumāra, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti, so tesam antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāham tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇam vaṭṭam nihitam anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahosī'ti.

9. Then, O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued

with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

atha kho ānanda, rañño makhādevassa putto kappakassa gāmvaram datvā jetṭhaputtam kumāram sādhuḥkam rajje samanussāsivā imasmimyeva makhādevambavane kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agāasmā anagāriyam pabbajji. so mettāsahagatena cetasā ekam disam pharivā vihāsi, tathā dutiyam, tathā tatiyam, tathā catutthim. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbatattāya¹ sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharivā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekam disam pharivā vihāsi, tathā dutiyam, tathā tatiyam, tathā catutthim. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbatattāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharivā vihāsi.

10. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Makhadeva's son amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the

office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world.

rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa putto caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīli, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agā-rasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedā parammaraṇā brahmalokūpago ahoṣi.

11. The sons of sons of king Makhadeva, O Ananda, eighty four thousand kattiyas in succession, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, they dwelled pervading

one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, they dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, they dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world they dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

rañño kho panānanda, makhādevassa puttappa-puttakā² tassa paramparā caturāsītikhattiyasahasāni³ imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane kesamasuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agā-rasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajimsu. te mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihariṃsu, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ.⁴ iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sab-bāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihariṃsu. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihariṃsu. tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sab-bāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihariṃsu.

12. For eighty four thousand years [as children] they

amused themselves with children games. For eighty four thousand years they occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years they ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, they went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, they fared on to the brahma world.

te caturāsītivassasahassāni kumārakīḷitaṃ kīḷiṃsu, caturāsītivassasahassāni oparajjaṃ¹ kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjaṃ kāresuṃ, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva makhādevambavane agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbajitā brahmacariyaṃ cariṃsu. te cattāro brahmavihāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brahmalokūpagā ahesuṃ.

13. King Nimi was the last of those kings, a righteous, lawful king who stood firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and he observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Once upon a time, O Ananda, the Tavatimsa devas, having assembled at the Sudhamma hall, this topic of conversation arose as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a

great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmiṇs and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.”

nimi tesam rājā rājānaṃ² pacchimako ahosi dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiṇca pakkhassa. bhūta-pubbaṃ ānanda, devānaṃ tāvatimsānaṃ sudhammāyaṃ sabhāyaṃ sannisinnānaṃ sannipatitānaṃ ayamantarākathā udapādi: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata bho videhānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiṇca pakkhassā’ti.

14. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed the Tavatimsa devas: Do you, dear sirs, wish to see king Nimi? We, dear sir, wish to see king Nimi. At that time, on the fifteenth day of the lunar fortnight, that being the uposatha day, king Nimi having washed his head, having gone to the upper floor of his lofty palace, was seated observing the uposatha. Then, O Ananda, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas,

disappeared among the Tavatimsa devas and appeared in front of king Nimi.

atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo deve tāva-
timse āmantesi: ‘iccheyyātha no tumhe mārīsā,
nimim rājānaṃ datṭhanti icchāma mayaṃ mārīsā,
nimim rājānaṃ datṭhanti. tena kho pana sama-
yena nimi rājā tadahuposathe pannarase sasīsaṃ
nahāto³ uposathiko upari pāsādavaragato nisinno
hoti. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo sey-
yathāpi nāma balavā puriso sammiñjitaṃ vā bā-
haṃ pasāreyya, pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ sammiñjeyya,
evamevaṃ devesu tāvatimsesu antarahito nimissa
rañño pamukhe pāturahosi.

15. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, said this to king Nimi: “It is a gain for you, great king, it is a good gain for you, great king. The Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, law-ful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. I, O great king, will send a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses for you. Climb aboard

that divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.” King Nimi, O Ananda, consented by silence. So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, having known of king Nimi’s consent, just as a strong man might bend back his outstretched arm or stretch out his bent arm, just so Sakka, ruler of the devas, disappeared in front of king Nimi and appeared among the Tavatimsa devas.

atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo nimiṃ rā-jānaṃ etadavoca: ‘lābhā te mahārāja, suladdhaṃ te mahārāja. devā te mahārāja, tāvatimsā sudham-māyaṃ sabhāyaṃ kittayamānarūpā sannisinnā: ‘lābhā vata bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata bho vi-dehānaṃ, yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhamma-rājā dhamme t̥hito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāh-maṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasiṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā’ti. devā te mahārāja, tāva-timsā dassanakāmā, tassa te ahaṃ mahārāja, sa-hassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ paṇiṇissāmi, abhiru-heyāsi mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno’ti. adhivāsesi kho ānanda, nimi rājā tuṇhībhāvena. atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo nimissa rañño adhivāsaṇaṃ viditvā seyyathāpi nāma balavā pu-riso samiñjitaṃ vā bāhaṃ pasāreyya, pasāritaṃ vā bāhaṃ samiñjeyya, evamevaṃ nimissa rañño pamukhe antarahito devesu tāvatimsesu pātura-hosi.

16. Then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: “Come you good Matali, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, you say thus: “This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.” “Yes Lord,” O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, having approached king Nimi, said thus: “This chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, O great king, has been sent by Sakka, ruler of the devas, for you. Climb aboard the divine vehicle, O great king, without hesitation.” “But great king, by what [route do you prefer to be] led by me? That by which those who do evil kamma experience the results of their evil kamma or that by which those who do good kamma experience the results of their good kamma?” “Just lead me, O Matali, by both.” Matali, the charioteer, O Ananda, led king Nimi to Sudhamma assembly hall. Sakka, ruler of the devas, O Ananda, saw king Nimi approaching from afar. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: “Come great king, welcome great king, the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, having assembled at the Sudhamma assembly hall, are singing your praises as they settled: “It is a gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, it is a good gain indeed sirs, for the videhans, for whom king Nimi is a righteous, lawful king who stand firm in the Dhamma, a great king who fares by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Household-

ers, town and country folks, and observes the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” We the Tavatimsa devas, O great king, wish to see you. Take delight, O great king, in divine power among the devas.” Enough, dear sir, lead me back just there to Mithila. There I will fare by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observe the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight.” So then, O Ananda, Sakka, ruler of the devas, addressed Matali, the charioteer: “Come you good Matali, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, lead king Nimi back just there to Mithila.” “Yes Lord,” O Ananda, Matali, the charioteer, having replied to Sakka, ruler of the devas, having harnessed a chariot drawn by a thousand thoroughbred horses, led king Nimi back just there to Mithila.

atha kho ānanda, sakko devānamindo mātalisāṅgāhakaṃ āmantesi: ehi tvaṃ samma mātali, sa-hassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ upasaṅkamitvā evaṃ vadesi: ‘ayaṃ te mahārāja, sa-hassayutto ājaññaratho sakkena devānamindena pesito. abhiruheyysī mahārāja, dibbaṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno’ti. evaṃ bhaddantavāti¹ kho ānanda, mātali saṅgāhako sakkassa devānamindassa pa-ṭissutvā sa-hassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ upasaṅkamitvā etadavoca: ‘ayaṃ te mahārāja, sa-hassayutto ājaññaratho sakkena devānamindena pesito, abhiruha mahārāja, dib-

baṃ yānaṃ avikampamāno. api ca mahārāja, ka-
 tamena taṃ nemi, yena vā pāpakammā pāpakā-
 naṃ kammānaṃ vipākaṃ paṭisaṃvedenti, yena
 vā kalyāṇakammā kalyāṇānaṃ kammānaṃ vipā-
 kaṃ paṭisaṃvedenti'ti? ubhayeneva maṃ mātali
 nehīti. sampāpesi² kho ānanda, mātalisaṅgāhako
 nimim rājānaṃ sudhammaṃ sabhaṃ.³ addasā kho
 ānanda, sakko devānamindo nimim rājānaṃ dū-
 ratova āgacchantaṃ. disvāna nimim rājānaṃ eta-
 davoca: ehi kho mahārāja, svāgataṃ⁴ mahārāja,
 devā te⁵ mahārāja, tāvatimsā sudhammāyaṃ sa-
 bhāyaṃ kittayamānarūpā sannisinnā: 'lābhā vata
 bho videhānaṃ, suladdhaṃ vata⁶ bho videhānaṃ,
 yesaṃ nimi rājā dhammiko dhammarājā dhamme
 tthito mahārājā dhammaṃ carati brāhmaṇagaha-
 patikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca. uposa-
 thañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcadasīṃ aṭṭha-
 miñca pakkhassā'ti. devā te mahārāja, tāvatimsā
 dassanakāmā, abhirama mahārāja, devesu devā-
 nubhāvenā'ti. alaṃ mārisa, tattheva maṃ mithi-
 laṃ paṭinetu. tatthāhaṃ dhammaṃ carissāmi brāh-
 maṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu ca,
 uposathañca upavasissāmi cātuddasiṃ pañcada-
 siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassā'ti. atha kho ānanda,
 sakko devānamindo mātali saṅgāhakaṃ āmantesi:
 ehi tvaṃ samma mātali, saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññara-
 thaṃ yojetvā nimim rājānaṃ tattheva mithilaṃ
 paṭinehīti. evaṃ bhaddantavāti kho ānanda, mā-
 tali saṅgāhako sakkassa devānamindassa paṭis-
 sutvā saḥassayuttaṃ ājaññarathaṃ yojetvā nimim

rājānaṃ tattheva mithilaṃ paṭinesi.

17. Just there, O Ananda, king Nimi fared by the Dhamma among Brahmins and Householders, town and country folks, and observed the uposatha on the fourteenth, fifteenth, and the eighth days of the lunar fortnight. Then, O Ananda, from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, king Nimi addressed his barber: “when, good barber, you can see that grey hairs have emerged on my head, then you should inform me.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber replied to king Nimi. Then from the lapse of many years, many hundreds of years, many thousands of years, many hundreds of thousands of years, O Ananda, the barber saw that grey hairs have emerged on king Nimi’s head. Having seen, he said this to king Nimi: “The divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on your head.” “Well then good barber, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in my cupped hand.” “Yes, your majesty,” O Ananda, the barber having replied to king Nimi, having carefully pulled out the grey hairs with tweezers, place them in king Nimi’s cupped hand.

tatra sudāṃ ānanda, nimi rājā dhammaṃ carati
brāhmaṇagahapatikesu negamesu ceva jānapadesu
ca, uposathañca upavasati cātuddasiṃ pañcada-
siṃ aṭṭhamiñca pakkhassa. atha kho ānanda, nimi

rājā bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ⁷ accayena kappakaṃ āmantesi: ‘yadā me samma kappaka, passeyyāsi sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni, atha me āroceyyāsi’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paccassosi. addasā kho ānanda, kappako bahunnaṃ vassānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasatānaṃ bahunnaṃ vassasahassānaṃ accayena nimissa rañño sirasmiṃ palitāni jātāni. disvāna nimīṃ rājānaṃ etadavoca: pātubhūtā kho devassa devadūtā, dissanti sirasmiṃ palitāni jātānī’ti. tena hi samma kappaka, tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā mama añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpehī’ti. evaṃ devāti kho ānanda, kappako nimissa rañño paṭissutvā tāni palitāni sādhukaṃ saṇḍāsena uddharitvā nimissa rañño añjalismiṃ patitṭhāpesi.

17. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi, having given an excellent village to the barber, having summoned his eldest son, the prince, said this: “My son prince, the divine messengers have appeared. The emergence of grey hairs have been seen on my head. Since human sensual pleasures have been enjoyed by me, [now is] the occasion to seek after celestial sensual pleasures. Come you my son prince, rule this kingdom. Now having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, I will go forth from the home life into homelessness. Well now my son prince, when you too can see that grey hairs emerge on your head, then having given an excellent village to

the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kindom, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, you should go forth from the home life into homelessness. Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man. Among a pair of individuals existing, O my son prince, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you my son prince, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let you not be my last man.”

atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā kappakassa gāmavaram datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram āmantāpetvā etadavoca: ‘pātubhūtā kho me tāta kumāra devadūtā, dissanti sirasmim palitāni jātāni, bhuttā kho pana me mānusakā kāmā, samayo dibbe kāme pariyesitum. ehi tvam tāta kumāra, imam rajjam paṭipajja. aham pana kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyam pabbajissāmi. tena hi tāta kumāra, yadā tvampi passeyyāsi sirasmim palitāni jātāni, atha kappakassa gāmavaram datvā jeṭṭhaputtam kumāram sādhuḥkam rajje samanūsāsivā kesamassum ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyam pabbajeyyāsi. yena me idam kalyāṇam vaṭṭam nihitam anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvam antimapuriso ahosi. yasmim kho tāta kumāra, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti so tesam

antimapuriso hoti. taṃ tāhaṃ tāta kumāra, evaṃ vadāmi: ‘yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ anuppavatteyyāsi, mā kho me tvaṃ antimapuriso ahoṣī’ti.

18. Then, O Ananda, king Nimi having given an excellent village to the barber, having thoroughly instructed the eldest son, the prince, in the kingdom, in this Makhadeva Mango Grove, having shaved off hair and beard, having put on the brownish robe, went forth from the home life into homelessness. With a mind imbued with metta, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with metta, abundant, exalted, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will. With a mind imbued with compassion, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with mudita, he dwelled pervading one direction. With a mind imbued with equanimity, he dwelled pervading one direction, likewise the second direction, likewise the third direction, likewise the fourth direction, above, below, around, to all beings in the entire world he dwelled pervading with a mind imbued with equanimity, abundant, grown great, immeasurable, and free from enmity and ill-will.

atha kho ānanda, nimi rājā kappakassa gāmava-
raṃ datvā jeṭṭhaputtaṃ kumāraṃ sādhukaṃ rajje

samanusāsītvā imasmimīyeva makhādevambavane kesamassuṃ ohāretvā kāsāyāni vatthāni acchādetvā agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so mettāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam mettāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi. karuṇāsahagatena cetasā -pe- muditāsahagatena cetasā -pe- upekkhāsahagatena cetasā ekaṃ disaṃ pharitvā vihāsi, tathā dutiyaṃ, tathā tatiyaṃ, tathā catutthiṃ. iti uddhamadho tiriyaṃ sabbadhi sabbattatāya sabbāvantam lokam upekkhāsahagatena cetasā vipulena mahaggatena appamāṇena averena abyāpajjhena pharitvā vihāsi.

19. For eighty four thousand years [as a child], O Ananda, king Nimi amused himself with children games. For eighty four thousand years he occupied the office of sub-king. For eighty four thousand years he ruled the kingdom. For eighty four thousand years, in this very Makhadeva Mango Grove, he went forth from the home life into homelessness to fare the life of purity. Having enculturated the four divine abidings, with the breakup of the body, after death, he fared on to the brahma world. King Nimi's son, O Ananda, was named Kalarajanaka. He did not go forth from the home life into homelessness. He cut off that good custom. He was the last man of

those.

nimi kho panānanda, rājā caturāsītivassasahas-
sāni kumārakīlitaṃ kīli, caturāsītivassasahassāni
oparajjaṃ kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni rajjaṃ
kāresi, caturāsītivassasahassāni imasmiṃyeva ma-
khādevambavane agārasmā anagāriyaṃ pabba-
jito brahmacariyaṃ cari. so cattāro brahmavi-
hāre bhāvetvā kāyassa bhedaṃ parammaraṇā brah-
malokūpago ahosi. nimissa kho panānanda, rañño
kalārajanako nāma putto ahosi. so na agārasmā
anagāriyaṃ pabbaji. so taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ sa-
mucchindi. so tesāṃ antimapuriso ahosi.

20. Now it might be, O Ananda, that it occurs to you thus: Surely some other person was king Makhadeva who laid down that good custom at that time. But this should not be seen thus. I was king Makhadeva at that time. I laid down that good custom. That good custom laid down by me was continued in succession by later generation. However, O Ananda, that good custom did not lead to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowledge, to supreme awakening, to nibbana, [but] only for arising in the brahma world.

siyā kho pana te ānanda, evamassa: añño nūna
tena samayena rājā makhādevo ahosi yena¹ taṃ
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitanti.² na kho panetaṃ ānanda,
evaṃ datṭhabbaṃ. ahaṃ tena samayena rājā ma-

khādevo ahoṣiṃ. ahaṃ taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ ni-
hiniṃ.³ mayā taṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihitaṃ pac-
chimā janatā anuppavattesi. taṃ kho panānanda,
kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ na nibbidāya na virāgāya na ni-
rodhāya na upasamāya na abhiññāya na sambo-
dhāya na nibbānāya saṃvattati, yāvadeva brah-
malokūpapattiyaṃ.

21. However, at present, O Ananda, this good custom laid down by me lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana.” And what at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana? It is just this noble eight-fold path. That is, right view, right thought, right speech, right action, right livelihood, right effort, right mindfulness, right samadhi. This, at present, O Ananda, is that good custom laid down by me which lead exclusively to attenuation, to fading away, to cessation, to peace, to supreme knowlege, to supreme awakening, to nibbana. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last man.” Among a pair of individuals existing, O Ananda, he who the cutting off of such a good custom comes to be, he becomes the last man of them. That I to you all, O Ananda, say thus: “Continue in succession this good custom laid down by me. Let none of you be my last

man.” This is what the Auspicious One said. Delighted, the venerable Ananda rejoiced in the Auspicious One’s words.

idaṃ kho paṇānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. katamā cānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati: ayameva ariyo aṭṭhaṅgiko maggo. seyyathidaṃ: sammādiṭṭhi sammāsaṅkappo sammāvācā sammākammanto sammāājīvo sammāvāyāmo sammāsati sammāsamādhī. idaṃ kho ānanda, etarahi mayā kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ ekantanibbidāya virāgāya nirodhāya upasamāya abhiññāya sambodhāya nibbānāya saṃvattati. taṃ vo ahaṃ ānanda, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ anuppavatteyyātha, mā kho me tumhe antimapurisā ahuvattha. yasmim̐ kho ānanda, purisayuge vattamāne evarūpassa kalyāṇassa vaṭṭassa samucchedo hoti so tesam̐ antimapuriso hoti. taṃ vo ahaṃ ānanda, evaṃ vadāmi: yena me idaṃ kalyāṇaṃ vaṭṭaṃ nihiṭaṃ anuppavatteyyātha. mā kho me tumhe antimapurisā ahuvatthā’ti. idamavoca bhagavā attamano āyasmā ānando bhagavato bhāsitaṃ abhinandīti.

